

Daily Economic Briefing

Monday 28 September 2026 | Window: Thu 24 Sept 20:00 ET – Sun 27 Sept 20:22 ET (Fri 25 Sept close/AH + weekend) | Research cutoff Sun 27 Sept 20:22 ET | Edition 29

Assumptions, corrections and status this edition

- Thursday 24 Sept Treasury closes, unresolved at last edition's cutoff, are now confirmed via Treasury's own official par-yield curve (cross-checked against FRED): 2-year 4.87%, 10-year 5.18%.^[22] Friday 25 Sept closed little changed: 2-year 4.81%, 10-year 5.17%.^{[22][23]}
- Open thread resolved: Costco's fuller market verdict on its Thursday-after-close Q4/FY2026 beat landed Friday, fully reversing the muted after-hours reaction (see Section 2).
- Open thread resolved: the front-end VIX/VIX9D inversion flagged last edition was noise — Friday's term structure reverted to a normal upward slope (see Section 5).
- Options-volume methodology mismatch (flagged last edition) substantially explained, not fully closed: Cboe's daily statistics page hosts several stacked category tables under one URL; Friday's "Sum of All Products" total is consistent with the prior "13.78m" reading, but the earlier "902,421" figure remains unattributed to a specific category (see Section 5).
- New, undisclosed-until-now data conflict: Friday's DXY reading from Yahoo Finance and Investing.com (both 100.97, down approx. 0.31-0.32%) runs directionally opposite to Friday's dollar-supportive FX-cross moves (see Section 4) — reported as a genuine, unreconciled split rather than picked one way.
- zerogex.io's Friday dealer-gamma read (net SPX GEX +\$32.56bn) is roughly 9x Thursday's +\$3.63bn — plausible given Friday's sharp VIX cooldown, but large enough to flag as a magnitude anomaly worth re-checking next edition rather than passing through silently (see Section 5).

60-second read

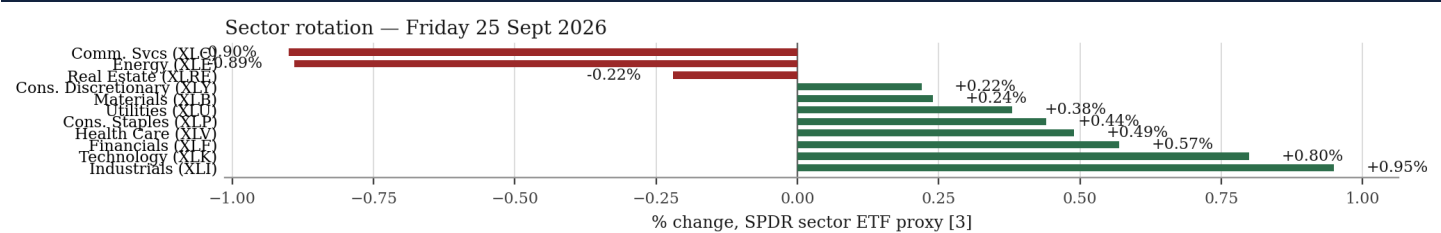
- A broad relief rally closed out the week:** S&P 500 +0.5% to 7,743.41, Dow +0.9% to 51,828.62, Nasdaq +0.5% to 27,068.72, Russell 2000 +0.1% to 2,837.55 — the index's first winning week in three, within 0.7% of its all-time high — as oil pulled back roughly 2% on US-Iran truce hopes and Treasury yields steadied after Thursday's spike.^{[1][2]}
- Meta Platforms fell 3.33%** after a Santa Fe, New Mexico jury found the company liable on a reported 43.9 million counts of consumer-protection-law violations tied to its handling of the Cambridge Analytica scandal, with a theoretical maximum exposure cited near \$219.5bn (a judge, not the jury, will set the final penalty) — reversing Thursday's Muse-driven rally and dragging Communication Services to Friday's worst-performing sector.^{[6][7]}
- Costco jumped 2.93%** to \$922.77, resolving the open thread from Thursday's muted after-hours reaction to its Q4/FY2026 beat (EPS \$6.75 vs. approx. \$6.55 consensus, comps +9.4%) into a clean "buy the beat" session.^[4]
- The weekend reopened the geopolitical risk that Friday's oil selloff had priced out:** a Saturday Houthi missile-and-drone barrage targeted Riyadh directly for the first time since the conflict resumed, and President Trump publicly rejected an Iranian proposal (delivered via Qatari mediators) to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days — though Tehran says no formal rejection was conveyed and Trump said Sunday he expects talks to resume this week. Unconfirmed early Monday coverage points to oil re-approaching Thursday's levels.^{[26][27][28]}
- Rate-path odds stayed contested, not settled:** Polymarket's October-hike probability held flat around 65% over the weekend; CME FedWatch secondary citations remain split between a likely-stale approx. 54% and a fresher-looking approx. 69-76% band.^{[24][25]} Separately, the US and China agreed over the weekend to a reported \$30bn tariff cut and a new bilateral AI dialogue following Friday's conclusion of the Trump-Xi summit — a incremental positive for Monday's open.^[17] Tuesday's August PCE print (8:30am ET) is the week's key data risk.^[29]

1. Market recap

S&P 500 7,743.41 +0.5%	Dow Jones 51,828.62 +0.9%	Nasdaq Comp. 27,068.72 +0.5%	Russell 2000 2,837.55 +0.1%	VIX 14.87 -5.1%	10-yr Treasury 5.17% -1bp
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Friday's session capped the index's first winning week in three: the S&P 500 closed within 0.7% of its record high as a roughly 2% pullback in oil and a pause in the Treasury-yield surge (10-year 5.17%, essentially flat vs. Thursday's now-confirmed 5.18%) let equities exhale after a volatile week bracketing the four-central-bank Thursday cluster and a 19-year Treasury-yield high.^{[1][22][23]} The calm did not survive the weekend: a fresh Houthi escalation against Saudi Arabia and a stalled US-Iran exchange over the Strait of Hormuz reopened the geopolitical premium that had driven Friday's oil relief, while a Santa Fe jury's verdict against Meta introduced a fresh, large idiosyncratic legal overhang into Monday's open.^{[6][26][28]}

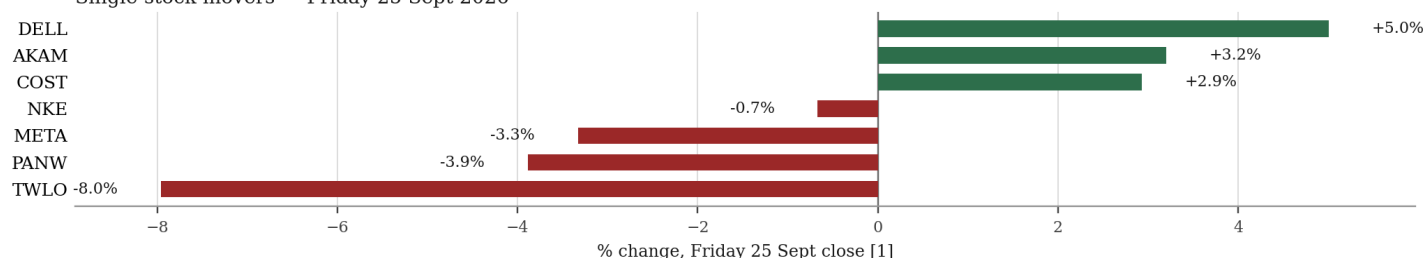
2. Equities and earnings



Leadership rotated out of Thursday's winner: Industrials (XLI +0.95%) and Technology (XLK +0.80%) led Friday's SPDR sector ETFs, with Financials (+0.57%), Health Care (+0.49%), Staples (+0.44%) and Utilities (+0.38%) also positive; Real Estate (-0.22%), Energy (-0.89%, still pressured by the oil pullback) and Communication Services (-0.90%, dragged by Meta's verdict) brought up the rear.^[3]

Single-stock movers

Single-stock movers — Friday 25 Sept 2026



Ticker	Move	Driver
Twilio (TWLO)	-7.96%	HSBC downgrade to Reduce (PT held \$211); argues the approx. 30% run-up since Meta's Sept 8 Muse debut overstated Twilio's slice of AI-agent "plumbing" revenue. ^[12]
Palo Alto Networks (PANW)	-3.89%	Confirmed at close via two independent sources; no single negative catalyst identified (the day's own PANW news was a new product launch) — reads as a valuation reset alongside Twilio in richly-priced AI-adjacent software, not company-specific news. ^[13]
Meta Platforms (META)	-3.33%	Santa Fe jury found approx. 43.9 million consumer-protection-law violations tied to the Cambridge Analytica scandal; theoretical exposure cited up to approx. \$219.5bn, final penalty to be set by the judge. Reverses Thursday's +4.50% Muse-driven rally. ^{[6][7]}
Nike (NKE)	-0.67%	BofA downgraded to Underperform from Neutral, cut PT to \$30 from \$47 (analyst Lorraine Hutchinson), pushing the sales-turnaround timeline to 2028. ^[10]
Costco (COST)	+2.93%	Full session verdict on Thursday's after-hours Q4/FY2026 beat (EPS \$6.75 vs. approx. \$6.55 consensus, comps +9.4%); a Goldman Sachs note reportedly turned bullish, though its exact revised price target could not be independently verified this run. ^{[4][5]}
Akamai (AKAM)	+3.20%	Announced an approx. \$11.6bn, 7-year cloud-infrastructure agreement with Anthropic. Note: intraday coverage cited moves as large as +16.4%; the verified close was far smaller — a clean intraday-vs-close divergence. ^[8]
Dell Technologies (DELL)	+5.01%	RBC Capital Markets initiated Outperform, \$640 PT; separate coverage cited a Morgan Stanley bull-case scenario price near \$756, tied to AI-server demand. ^[9]

A notable snapshot-vs-close trap surfaced in storage names: several aggregators reported Seagate, Western Digital and SanDisk down sharply "ahead of the open" Friday on Treasury-yield pressure and memory-oversupply fears, but all three actually closed higher (STX +1.20%, WDC +1.44%, SNDK +1.38%) after an intraday reversal — a clean example of the pre-market-quote-mistaken-for-close pitfall this report watches for.^[14] Elsewhere, Comcast fell 0.99% after KeyBanc downgraded to Underweight (\$18 PT) on broadband share losses and theme-park pressure, and Clorox rose 2.44% (contradicting at least one aggregator that had it as a decliner; the verified close is a gain).^{[11][15]} A broader analyst-action tally for Friday (39 upgrades, 12 downgrades) also included Wells Fargo initiating a cluster of industrial names (Carrier, Dover, Eaton, Emerson, Johnson Controls, Trane, Vertiv) at Overweight, Synopsys raised to Buy at HSBC, and Humana raised to Overweight at Barclays.^[16]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh and the next FOMC meeting (Oct 27-28, 2026) were both reconfirmed fresh against federalreserve.gov's own calendar; the Bank of England's Nov 5 and Bank of Japan's Oct 29-30 decision dates were likewise re-checked and remain unchanged.^{[18][19][20][21]} October rate-hike odds were essentially flat over the weekend and remain contested across venues: Polymarket showed a 25bp hike at approx. 65% (no-change approx. 34%), little changed from Thursday's approx. 65-67%; CME FedWatch's official tool would not load directly, and secondary citations split three ways — approx. 54% (very likely a stale republic of an earlier read), an undated approx. 69%, and a Friday-dated approx. 75.8%, leaving the effective range closer to approx. 69-76% than a single number. Kalshi's direct fetch failed a seventh consecutive edition (HTTP 429), a confirmed structural gap.^{[24][25]}

Treasury yields: Thursday 24 Sept's closes, unresolved at last edition's cutoff, are now confirmed via Treasury's own official daily par-yield curve (cross-checked against FRED) at 2-year 4.87% and 10-year 5.18%; Friday 25 Sept closed little changed at 2-year 4.81% and 10-year 5.17%. Thursday's exact intraday 10-year high remains only secondary-sourced, in a range of approx. 5.10-5.22%, with approx. 5.22% better corroborated by coverage calling it the highest since June 2007.^{[22][23]} The CFTC's weekly Commitment of Traders report posted on schedule Friday, dated Tuesday 22 Sept (a 3-day publication lag): equity-index futures show Asset Managers net long roughly 934,000-936,000 E-mini S&P contracts against Leveraged Funds net short roughly 376,000 — a heavily one-sided positioning split that predates this week's volatility and should be read with that lag in mind.^[31]

Over the weekend, following Friday's conclusion of the three-day Trump-Xi summit, the US and China reportedly agreed to a \$30bn tariff cut on a range of goods in both directions plus a new bilateral AI dialogue (first round of talks slated for November) — elaborating on, not superseding, the trade truce Treasury Secretary Bessent confirmed extends to January 10, 2027.^[17] Separately, a fresh Houthi missile-and-drone attack on Saturday targeted Riyadh directly for the first time since the conflict resumed (intercepted, no fatalities reported) and prompted Saudi retaliation on Taiz, Yemen; President Trump publicly rejected a Qatari-mediated Iranian proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days, though Iran's foreign minister said Sunday no formal rejection had been conveyed and Trump separately said he expects talks to resume this week.^{[26][27][28]}

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Level	Chg	Note
WTI crude	\$92.41	-2.3%	November contract both days; no roll mismatch ^[33]
Brent crude	\$104.32	-2.1%	Eased on US-Iran truce hopes; reversed most of the pullback over the weekend ^[33]
Gold (USAGOLD)	\$4,280.19	+0.12%	Kitco's last print ran approx. \$4.78 higher — a mild re-widening from Thursday's \$0.16 gap, not a reopened split ^{[35][36]}
Silver (USAGOLD)	\$64.04	+0.33%	^[35]

Copper (Westmetall)	\$14,740.00/t	-0.17%	LME cash via Westmetall, the standing fallback (lme.com/metal.com both down 8 editions running) ^[37]
DXY	100.97	-0.31%	Genuine cross-source conflict — see note below ^[39]
EUR/USD	1.1375	-0.06%	^[38]
GBP/USD	1.3211	-0.24%	^[38]
USD/JPY	158.81	+0.35%	Dollar up vs. yen ^[38]

Oil fell roughly 2% Friday (Brent \$104.32, WTI \$92.41, both cleanly on the November contract) as rising hope for a US-Iran truce and a phased Hormuz reopening offset continuing Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia; the week-on-week picture diverged sharply, with Brent essentially flat but WTI down roughly 8%.^[33] That calm did not last the weekend: Saturday's direct Houthi strike on Riyadh and Trump's rejection of Iran's proposal reopened the risk premium, and unconfirmed early Monday coverage points to both benchmarks re-approaching Thursday's levels — not confirmed against a primary print and not treated as a Friday closing figure here.^{[26][27][28]} Gold's Kitco-vs-USAGOLD gap, which had closed to \$0.16 last edition, ticked back up to roughly \$4.78 Friday — still far short of the approx. \$50 gap seen two editions ago, so treated as normal vendor noise rather than a reopened divergence.^{[35][36]} The dollar carries a genuine, unreconciled split into Monday: Yahoo Finance and Investing.com both show DX Y down 0.31-0.32% to 100.97, which runs directly opposite to Friday's own FX-cross moves — EUR/USD, GBP/USD and USD/JPY all point to modest dollar strength, not weakness. Disclosed as-is rather than forced to one story; it is plausible other basket currencies (CAD, SEK, CHF) moved against the dollar enough to flip the index, but that is not confirmed.^{[38][39]}

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

The Cboe delayed-quotes feed delivered a second consecutive full, individually timestamp-verified clean sweep Friday (every series' `last_trade_time` dated 25 Sept): VIX 14.87 (-5.11%, computed manually against the feed's own duplicated prev-close field, a bug now confirmed for an eighth straight edition), VIX9D 12.76 (-9.57%), VIX3M 17.93 (-2.71%), VIX6M 20.01 (-1.67%), VVIX 87.84 (-3.01%), SKEW 144.91 (-0.77%).^[40] Thursday's flagged front-end inversion (spot VIX above VIX9D) did not recur: Friday's term structure reverted to a normal upward slope (VIX9D < VIX < VIX3M < VIX6M), resolving that open thread as noise rather than a fresh pattern.^[40]

Cboe's options-volume page substantially resolved last edition's methodology puzzle: the URL hosts several stacked category tables (Sum of All Products, Index, Equity, Exchange-Traded Products, VIX, SPX+SPXW), each with its own volume total. Friday's Sum-of-All-Products total (13,939,864 contracts) sits in the same range as the previously-logged "13.78m" figure, suggesting that reading was this all-products category; the earlier, much smaller 902,421 figure still cannot be matched to any category visible today and remains unattributed — treat it as unresolved rather than comparable to either all-products total. Friday's VIX-specific options volume was 609,823 contracts (474,086 calls, 135,737 puts), a put/call ratio of 0.29.^[41] SpotGamma failed direct fetch for a seventh straight edition; zerogex.io, now the standing default, showed Friday's SPX net gamma exposure at a striking +\$32.56bn (gamma flip 7,680, call wall 7,800, put wall 7,700) — roughly 9x Thursday's +\$3.63bn. Directionally consistent with Friday's sharp VIX decline pushing dealers deeper into positive-gamma territory, but the magnitude of the jump is large enough to flag rather than pass through uncritically; worth re-checking for a repeat or a correction next edition.^[42] CFTC CoT VIX-futures positioning (CFE legacy report, also dated 22 Sept): non-commercial (large speculator) accounts net short approx. 79,300 contracts, modestly less short than the approx. 86,600 logged for 15 Sept — a slight reduction in short-vol positioning, still pre-dating this week's swings.^[31] Funding: SOFR's most recent published print, Thursday 24 Sept, held at 3.88% on \$2.99tn of volume with no stress signal in the percentile bands; Friday's print had not yet posted within this window (publishes the next business day).^[43]

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Tue 30 Sept, 8:30am ET	PCE inflation (Aug), Personal Income and Outlays	Headline approx. +0.4% m/m / 3.7% y/y; core approx. +0.3% m/m / 3.3% y/y. BEA's concurrent annual benchmark revisions could mechanically shave approx. 0.2pp off the y/y prints per one desk estimate. ^{[29][30]}
Wed 1 Oct	ISM Manufacturing (Sept)	Consensus approx. 54.8-55.0 vs. 54.6 prior; prices-paid seen approx. 72 vs. 71.1 ^[30]
Fri 2 Oct, 8:15/8:30am ET	ADP private payrolls; September jobs report	ADP consensus approx. +70k. Nonfarm payrolls consensus approx. +100k (vs. +162k Aug); unemployment rate seen ticking up to approx. 4.2% from 4.1% ^[30]
This week	US-Iran talks on a phased Hormuz reopening	President Trump said Sunday he expects talks to resume; no fixed date confirmed ^[28]
Fri 2 Oct	Next CFTC Commitment of Traders report	Would cover Tue 29 Sept, the first read to capture this week's positioning ^[31]

Sector setup we take into Monday's session

- Energy: Friday's approx. 2% pullback looks fragile into Monday given Saturday's direct Houthi strike on Riyadh and the stalled US-Iran Hormuz exchange — watch for a reversal higher at the open.
- Communication Services: Meta's fresh legal overhang (up to approx. \$219.5bn theoretical exposure) is an ongoing risk, not a one-day event — watch for follow-through selling or opportunistic buying.
- Consumer Staples: Costco's clean resolution of its earnings open thread (+2.93%) sets a constructive tone heading into the week.
- AI-adjacent software: Twilio and Palo Alto Networks both fell on valuation-reset grounds rather than fresh company-specific bad news — a read-through worth watching across richly-priced names in the group.
- Storage/hardware (STX, WDC, SNDK): Friday's sharp pre-market-to-close reversal muddies the memory-oversupply narrative; a name group to watch for continued two-way volatility.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- Exact Goldman Sachs, Wells Fargo and Bernstein price targets on Costco post-earnings — conflicting figures across sources, two source pages blocked (403)
- Palo Alto Networks' specific Friday catalyst — move confirmed at close, no negative company-specific news identified
- Storage-stock (STX/WDC/SNDK) specific catalyst for the pre-market-to-close reversal — general oversupply/yields narrative found, no single Friday news item pinned to the reversal
- TradingEconomics' exact Friday DXY reading — historical table not exposed to direct fetch; cannot confirm whether Thursday's Yahoo-vs-TradingEconomics split persisted
- Henry Hub natural gas Friday % change — only a single unverified aggregator figure found; EIA/CME primary sources inaccessible
- Friday 25 Sept SOFR print — publishes the next business day, not yet available within this window
- The specific Cboe options-volume table/category behind the previously-logged 902,421-contract figure — mechanism (multiple stacked tables per URL) now understood, this specific historical reading still unmatched
- Thursday 24 Sept's exact 10-year Treasury intraday high — only secondary-sourced, in an approx. 5.10-5.22% range
- Exact release date for August JOLTS job openings this week — consensus figure found (approx. 7.23mn) but not an independently confirmed release date
- Reported intensification of Israeli operations in South Lebanon over the weekend — single aggregator source, not corroborated by a major wire
- A longer list of secondary single-stock movers circulated by one unverified aggregator (including MRNA, SWKS, FLEX, HPQ, NTAP, FIX) — not reported as fact given two other names from the same list were confirmed wrong on direction at the close

Annex B — Sources

- [1] AP "How major US stock indexes fared" (via WTOP), Fri 25 Sept 2026, timestamped 4:20pm ET
- [2] Yahoo Finance ^RUT historical prices, cross-check
- [3] Stockanalysis.com SPDR sector ETF price-history pages (XLE/XLK/XLC/XLY/XLP/XLRE/XLF/XLB/XLI/XLU/XLV), close 25 Sept 2026
- [4] Stockanalysis.com COST history table, close 25 Sept 2026, timestamped 4:00pm EDT
- [5] CNBC, Costco/Goldman Sachs coverage, 25 Sept 2026
- [6] US News, Meta Santa Fe jury verdict, dated 25 Sept 2026
- [7] Fortune / ppc.land / Engadget, Meta verdict corroboration, 25 Sept 2026
- [8] Akamai press release / CNBC, Anthropic cloud deal, 25 Sept 2026
- [9] Reuters/Bloomberg coverage, RBC and Morgan Stanley Dell notes, 25 Sept 2026
- [10] Bloomberg, BofA Nike downgrade, dated 25 Sept 2026
- [11] Multiple outlets, KeyBanc Comcast downgrade, 25 Sept 2026
- [12] Coverage of HSBC Twilio downgrade, 25 Sept 2026
- [13] Stockanalysis.com PANW history; GuruFocus/MarketBeat/TradingKey secondary coverage
- [14] Stockanalysis.com STX/WDC/SNDK history tables, close 25 Sept 2026
- [15] Stockanalysis.com CLX history table, close 25 Sept 2026
- [16] Daily Trade Alert, analyst upgrades/downgrades roundup, dated 25 Sept 2026
- [17] CNBC, US-China tariff cut and AI dialogue, 26 Sept 2026
- [18] Federalreserve.gov, FOMC meeting calendar, fetched fresh
- [19] CNBC, "Warshi's regime change at the Fed," 25 Sept 2026 (Fed Chair confirmation)
- [20] Bankofengland.co.uk, MPC decision dates page, fetched fresh
- [21] Boj.or.jp, Monetary Policy Meeting schedule, fetched fresh
- [22] Home.treasury.gov, daily par yield curve (CSV), Thu-Fri, cross-checked against FRED DGS2/DGS10
- [23] CNBC, "10-year yield little changed to end a volatile week," 25 Sept 2026
- [24] Polymarket, October FOMC rate-decision market, direct fetch
- [25] CME FedWatch secondary citations (aggregated desk/press references, dated variously)
- [26] Washington Post, Trump rejects Iran Hormuz proposal, 26 Sept 2026
- [27] NBC News, Iran says no formal rejection conveyed, 27 Sept 2026
- [28] Critical Threats / The National, Houthis attack on Riyadh, 26 Sept 2026
- [29] BEA.gov, PCE release schedule, fetched fresh
- [30] Week-ahead consensus previews, multiple economic-calendar aggregators
- [31] CFTC.gov, financial_if.htm and legacy CFE reports (deacboelf.htm/deacboes.htm), dated 22 Sept 2026, published 25 Sept 2026
- [33] Reuters wire via Yahoo Finance/BOE Report/AOL and Investing.com WTI historical data, oil closes 25 Sept 2026
- [35] USAGOLD Daily Precious Metals Market Report, 25 Sept 2026
- [36] Kitco News, gold coverage, 25 Sept 2026
- [37] Westmetall.com, LME cash copper settlement table
- [38] Yahoo Finance FX historical pages (EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY)
- [39] Yahoo Finance DX-Y.NYB and Investing.com US Dollar Index historical data
- [40] Cboe cdn.cboe.com delayed-quotes JSON, direct fetch per series with last_trade_time verification
- [41] Cboe US Options Daily Market Statistics page, embedded data payload, 25 Sept 2026
- [42] zerogex.io SPX gamma-levels page, as-of 25 Sept 2026
- [43] New York Fed markets API, SOFR rate, latest print 24 Sept 2026

Method: every figure traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed. Nothing estimated or filled from memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A. Not investment advice.